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Manger, feed trough, feedbox

1.2.3 Manger, feed trough, feedbox

References:

Hebrew אֵבוּס (’evus) JOB 39:9, PRO 14:4, ISA 1:3

Greek φάτνη (fatnē) LUK 2:7, LUK 2:12, LUK 2:16

Description and usage:

Feed and water troughs in the stables at Megiddo (© Immanuel Giel, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons)The manger was a trough, made of stone or wood, where animals fed, possibly even an open feeding place under the sky.

Translation:

It may be important in some languages to distinguish between various alternatives. A “feed trough” or “manger” normally refers to a relatively large box or rack containing hay, where an animal stands when it feeds; a “feedbox” is a much smaller container, usually for grain. There is no way of knowing precisely where the baby Jesus was placed in LUK 2:7, but it would have been appropriate for the baby to be placed in the feedbox or in the manger.